This soup was originally a way to use the leftover catch of the day in Brittany. Try it with haddock, smoked haddock, pollock, or cod.

cotriade (fish stew)

SERVES 4 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 30 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

2 large floury potatoes, peeled
2 tbsp peanut, sunflower, or mild olive oil
2 tbsp butter
2 Spanish onions, coarsely chopped
1 quart (1 liter) light fish stock
3 sprigs of thyme
3 bay leaves
3 sprigs of flat-leaf parsley
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
1¾lb (800g) mixed fish, skinned and cut into large chunks
4 thick slices country bread, to serve

for the dressing
5–6 tbsp peanut, sunflower, or mild olive oil
½ tsp Dijon mustard
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper
1 tbsp white wine or cider vinegar
2 tbsp finely chopped parsley

1 Cut the potatoes into quarters and set aside. Heat the oil and butter in a large, heavy sauté pan over medium heat. Add the onions and soften until just golden, stirring frequently. Add the stock, then add in the potatoes and herbs. Season lightly with salt and pepper, stir, cover, and cook for 12–15 minutes or until the potatoes are almost cooked.

2 Place the fish in the pan and season lightly. Gently stir, then cook for 7–10 minutes, or until the fish just starts to flake when pierced with a fork. If you are freezing the soup, cool and do so now. Meanwhile, make the dressing. In a small bowl, mix together the oil and mustard. Season with salt and pepper, then whisk in the vinegar until emulsified. Stir in the parsley.

3 Remove the soup from the heat and adjust the seasoning. Remove the herbs. Put the bread in 4 warm bowls and moisten with a little dressing. Ladle the soup over the top and drizzle on the remaining dressing. Serve hot.